

module-04-doshas - Darshana (60-min workshop)

IKS Curriculum - middle band

Module 4 — Doshas — Vāta, Pitta, Kapha (Darśana)

Sanskrit: *Tri-doṣa* · **Band:** Middle (6-8) · **Duration:** 60 min · **Path:** Darśana (Workshop)

Three biological rhythms in Āyurvedic thought.

Darśana note. This workshop condenses Module 4’s full 10-day arc into one hour. For the deeper version — daily lesson plans, quizzes, assessments, slide decks — switch to [Adhyayana](#) (the Full Course path).

Opening hook · 5 min

“Describe three students you know — without naming them — one sentence each, focusing on their energy and pace.” Pair-share. Most descriptions cluster around: quick, focused, steady. These are the doṣas.

Core idea · 15 min

Three doṣas:

Doṣa	Element pair	Quality	Style
Vāta	ākāśa + vāyu	mobile, dry, cold	quick, changeable
Pitta	tejas + ap	hot, sharp, intense	focused, transformative
Kapha	ap + pṛthvī	heavy, cool, stable	steady, calm

Critical: *prakṛti* (innate ratio, lifelong) vs *vikṛti* (current state, fluctuates). Self-observation, NOT diagnosis. Refer health concerns to a doctor.

Demonstration · 10 min

Doṣa-style observation. Pairs swap notes for 5 minutes. Each describes the other: pace of speech, body type, sleep pattern, food preferences. Then each labels themselves with the doṣa ratio that best fits.

Source moment · 5 min

Paraphrase Caraka Sūtrasthāna 1.57: “*The three doṣas — vāta, pitta, kapha — are the foundation of all bodily processes.*”

Hands-on activity · 15 min

Personal doṣa-rhythm clock. Each student marks the kapha (morning), pitta (noon), vāta (evening) hours on a 24-hour circle. Annotate when YOU feel each doṣa dominant. Share with a partner.

Reflection + take-home · 10 min

“*After this workshop, what’s ONE doṣa-aware change you might try? What might get in the way?*”

Go deeper into Adhyayana

The 10 days you’re skipping if you only do this workshop:

- **Day 01** — Three doṣas — introduction
- **Day 02** — Vāta — the motion principle
- **Day 03** — Pitta — the transformation principle
- **Day 04** — Kapha — the structure principle
- **Day 05** — Mapping doṣas to the five elements (Module 2)
- **Day 06** — Prakṛti self-assessment
- **Day 07** — Daily doṣa rhythms (kapha morning, pitta noon, vāta evening)
- **Day 08** — Seasonal doṣa rhythms
- **Day 09** — Balance vs imbalance (sāmya vs vaiṣamya)
- **Day 10** — Synthesis + 7-day self-observation project

→ [Open the Adhyayana track for this module](#) to access all 10 days, the 4-audience PDFs, the slide deck, the quizzes, and the project rubric.